



Google Summer of Code starts off in 2 months from now so you better start preparing. Head over to <http://dgit.in/Gsoc15>

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The good design playbook

>> Good design is more complicated than you'd think. Find out what goes into good UX > by Varad Choudhari

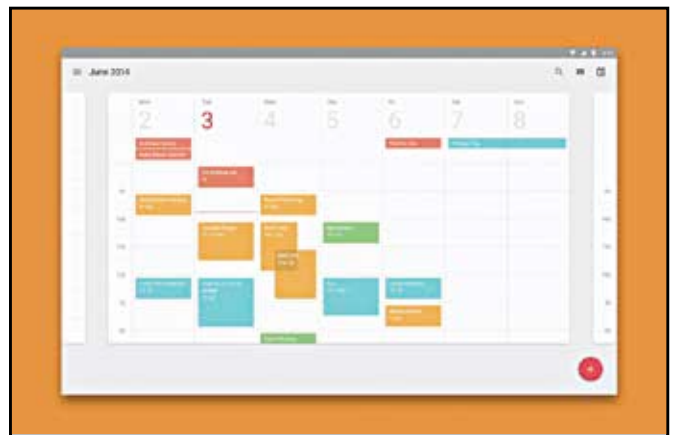
You might have heard of the term 'UX' quite often. Ever wonder what it is? Or did you merely dismiss it thinking that it's something related to the UI? The UX has become an important part of the product development cycle. Many industries are hiring UX professionals to shape their product. If you've always been curious about the term, here's an in-depth guide to introduce you to UX.

What is UX?

UX is an acronym for 'User Experience'. It defines how a user feels while interacting with the system. The system could be anything – a website, a mobile app or even a desktop app. UX shouldn't be confused with UI, as both are entirely different concepts. Here's a brief explanation of both concepts.

- **UI:** This is an acronym for 'User Interface'. It deals with how a website or an application looks. It covers the entire look of the application including the colors, fonts, icons and images used. The user interface is entirely about the visual and interface design.
- **UX:** It deals with how easily a user can, well, use the app and how easily the app would serve to satisfy his requirements.

Consider this example: Say, you're making a mobile app. When designing the interface (UI) of your app, you should not only con-



The all-new minimal 'Material Design' by Google

sider how great your app will look, but also how easy it will be to use, i.e. how great the user experience (UX) will be.

Suppose your UI looks exceptionally good (think: along the lines of Google products), however, after opening your app the user doesn't understand what he's supposed to do next. Then, no matter how great your app looks, it will be completely useless.

*coding matters



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